

"We Do Not Well"

II Kings 7:1-9 *"Then Elisha said, Hear ye the word of the LORD; Thus saith the LORD, Tomorrow about this time shall a measure of fine flour be sold for a shekel, and two measures of barley for a shekel, in the gate of Samaria.*

2 Then a lord on whose hand the king leaned answered the man of God, and said, Behold, if the LORD would make windows in heaven, might this thing be? And he said, Behold, thou shalt see it with thine eyes, but shalt not eat thereof.

3 And there were four leprous men at the entering in of the gate: and they said one to another, Why sit we here until we die?

4 If we say, We will enter into the city, then the famine is in the city, and we shall die there: and if we sit still here, we die also. Now therefore come, and let us fall unto the host of the Syrians: if they save us alive, we

shall live; and if they kill us, we shall but die.

⁵ *And they rose up in the twilight, to go unto the camp of the Syrians: and when they were come to the uttermost part of the camp of Syria, behold, there was no man there.*

⁶ *For the LORD had made the host of the Syrians to hear a noise of chariots, and a noise of horses, even the noise of a great host: and they said one to another, Lo, the king of Israel hath hired against us the kings of the Hittites, and the kings of the Egyptians, to come upon us.*

⁷ *Wherefore they arose and fled in the twilight, and left their tents, and their horses, and their asses, even the camp as it was, and fled for their life.*

⁸ *And when these lepers came to the uttermost part of the camp, they went into one tent, and did eat and drink, and carried thence silver, and gold, and raiment, and went and hid it; and came again, and entered*

into another tent, and carried thence also, and went and hid it.

⁹ *Then they said one to another, We do not well: this day is a day of good tidings, and we hold our peace: if we tarry till the morning light, some mischief will come upon us: now therefore come, that we may go and tell the king's household.*

INTRO: Let's go back and pick up on some events leading up to our opening scripture and set the scene for today.

The Bible says Benhadad, the king of the Syrians, warred against Israel. The problem was, however, that every time Benhadad set up an ambush for Israel, Elisha would tell Jehoram, the king of Israel, about it, thus the enemy's plot was foiled!

We've got a lot of folks today who claim to have a word from The Lord!

This happened several times and it caused Benhadad to begin to believe he had someone close to him leaking private information to the enemy!

He began trying to find out. However, one of his servants endeavored to answer him in this manner, notice:

II Kings 6:12 *"And one of his servants said, "None, my lord, O king; but Elisha, the prophet who is in Israel, tells the king of Israel the words that you speak in your bedroom."*

Benhadad sent men to find out where Elisha was, probably intending to kill this man of God!

They found him in Dothan and notice what drastic measures Benhadad went to capture Elisha:

II Kings 6:14-15 *"Therefore he sent horses and chariots and a great army there, and they came by night and surrounded the city. 15 And when the servant of the man of God arose early and went out, there was an army, surrounding the city with horses and chariots. And his servant said to him, "Alas, my master! What shall we do?"*

Elisha's servant saw them and became very concerned, but notice how Elisha responds to him in:

II Kings 6:16 *"So he answered, "Do not fear, for those who are with us are more than those who are with them."*

It may not look like it in the flesh!

Elisha prayed and God smote the Syrians with blindness. He led them to Samaria and prayed and God opened their eyes!

The king of Israel wanted to kill them, but Elisha wouldn't let him and notice what he does:

II Kings 6:22-23 *"But he answered, "You shall not kill them. Would you kill those whom you have taken captive with your sword and your bow? Set food and water before them, that they may eat and drink and go to their master." 23 Then he prepared a great feast for them; and after they ate and drank, he sent them away and they went to their master. So the bands of Syrian raiders came no more into the land of Israel."*

In the latter part of chapter 6 we find Samaria in a sad, sad situation. This ungrateful king Benhadad had once again gathered all his armies together with the determination of conquering Israel and making it part of his kingdom!

Benhadad brought all his forces together and besieged the capital city, Samaria!

Benhadad was a pretty mean fellow, for he cut off all communication between Samaria and the rest of the nation!

Satan has made an effort to starve the church by cutting off communication with Heaven!

There was no way to get food and supplies into the cities, thus there was a great famine in the city.

There is a famine in this world as well today!

Benhadad was slowly starving the Samaritans to death!

The famine had become so great that **II Kings 6:25** says “*And there was a great famine in Samaria; and indeed they*

besieged it until a donkey's head was sold for eighty shekels of silver, and one-fourth of a kab of dove droppings for five shekels of silver. ”

Do you understand the gravity of the situation here? Do you understand the seriousness of this situation?

A donkey's head was worth \$51.20!
One pint of dove's dung soup was worth \$3.20!

Every morning those people would go around scraping up the droppings where the doves had roosted so they could make doves' dung soup!

Notice how bad the famine got:

II Kings 6:26-29 “Then, as the king of Israel was passing by on the wall, a woman cried out to him, saying, “Help, my lord, O king!” 27 And he said, “If the Lord does not

help you, where can I find help for you?
From the threshing floor or from the
winepress?” 28 Then the king said to her,
“What is troubling you?”

And she answered, “This woman said to me,
‘Give your son, that we may eat him today,
and we will eat my son tomorrow.’”²⁹ *So we*
boiled my son, and ate him. And I said to her
on the next day, ‘Give your son, that we
may eat him’; but she has hidden her son.”

When the king heard this he decided he
would kill Elisha because Elisha has allowed
the Syrians to escape when they could have
been killed.

Elisha’s popularity plummeted and when
Jehoram comes to get Elisha to kill, him
Elisha begins to prophesy:

II Kings 7:1 *“Then Elisha said, “Hear the
word of the Lord. Thus says the Lord:
‘Tomorrow about this time a seah of fine
flour shall be sold for a shekel, and two*

seahs of barley for a shekel, at the gate of Samaria. ’’

It was time to start prophesying!

Notice this prophecy: a peck of flour and barley would be sold for 64 cents!

He wasn't talking about a year down the road, but he says TOMORROW!

Not everybody believed it!

II Kings 7:2 “So an officer on whose hand the king leaned answered the man of God and said, “Look, *if the* Lord would make windows in heaven, could this thing be?”

And he said, “In fact, you shall see *it* with your eyes, but you shall not eat of it.”

Notice verses 3-4 ‘Now there were four leprous men at the entrance of the gate; and they said to one another, “Why are we sitting here until we die? 4 If we say, ‘We will enter the city,’ the famine *is* in the city,

and we shall die there. And if we sit here, we die also. Now therefore, come, let us surrender to the army of the Syrians. If they keep us alive, we shall live; and if they kill us, we shall only die.”

Thank God someone decided to do something about the famine:

Verse 4 “*If we say, ‘We will enter the city,’ the famine is in the city, and we shall die there. And if we sit here, we die also. Now therefore, come, let us surrender to the army of the Syrians. If they keep us alive, we shall live; and if they kill us, we shall only die.*”

These guys were outcasts! Their fingers and toes has been eaten away by leprosy. They were a pitiful group!

If the situation in Samaria was so bad that horses were nowhere to be found, because people were eating them, plus some of the

best food left in the city was mule's head and doves dung soup, think how bad it must have been in the leper colony!

They made a decision to go to the camp of the Syrians and when they got there no one was home! Why?

Notice verses 6-7 “For the Lord had caused the army of the Syrians to hear the noise of chariots and the noise of horses—the noise of a great army; so they said to one another, “Look, the king of Israel has hired against us the kings of the Hittites and the kings of the Egyptians to attack us!” 7 Therefore they arose and fled at twilight, and left the camp intact—their tents, their horses, and their donkeys—and they fled for their lives.”

I can see these lepers now, they went into the first tent, and sure enough there was roasted lambs legs, biscuits and gravy and

just about everything else you can imagine to eat!

They ate until they were full, and I can almost see them cramming their pockets full of food and took the valuables from the tents and hid them.

I believe they probably repeated that process several times and then notice in:

Verse 9 *“Then they said one to another, We do not well: this day is a day of good tidings, and we hold our peace: if we tarry till the morning light, some mischief will come upon us: now therefore come, that we may go and tell the king's household.”*

NKJV *“Then they said to one another, “We are not doing right. This day is a day of good news, and we remain silent. If we wait until morning light, some punishment will*

come upon us. Now therefore, come, let us go and tell the king's household."

LISTEN, "*We do not well*" if we do not share our experience with others!

Our lives have been touched by the hand of God; we have been blessed by a mighty manifestation of God's holy power, yet "*We do not well*" if we keep it to ourselves!

This is experience that you have, deserves to be shared with everyone we come across!

EXAMPLE: Four Men Bring Their Sick Friend to Jesus

There was a crowd soaking up the blessing and the presence of God

Mark 2:1-2 "And again He entered Capernaum after *some* days, and it was heard that He was in the

house. 2 Immediately many gathered together, so that there was no longer room to receive *them*, not even near the door. And He preached the word to them.”

They were enjoying the Word so much that they wouldn't even step aside so that a need could be met

Verses 3-4 “Then they came to Him, bringing a paralytic who was carried by four *men*. 4 And when they could not come near Him because of the crowd, they uncovered the roof where He was. So when they had broken through, they let down the bed on which the paralytic was lying.”

My question is, how selfish could they be?

Thank God for the four friends who wouldn't give up!

Verse 4 “*And* when they could not come near Him because of the crowd, they uncovered the roof where He was. So when they had broken through, they let down the bed on which the paralytic was lying.”

Because of persistence, a need was met
Because of persistence, a life was changed
Because of persistence, someone will never
be the same again

MY QUESTION IS: Have we received?

If so, what are we going to do about others
who have not?